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Digital

# Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

## Concocting Dreams

**When it comes to technology in movie-making, India is, admittedly, just catching up. But we're getting there pretty fast**

Aditya Kuber

**L**ustre, Flint, Smoke, Combustion, Fire, Flame... no, we're not talking about making a bomb! These are the software used today to digitally enhance a movie—or create scenes for one. The way it's done is quite marvellous, and very often you don't notice that there's a computer at work behind the scenes, literally. We take a look here at where India stands in the adoption of the computer as a tool in movie-making.

India lags behind Hollywood (or for that matter, most technologically-advanced countries that make movies) in implementing advanced

editing technologies, but we're certainly catching up. We're quickly learning the new art of creating things that cannot be shot through the camera.

There was a time when movies were made with a camera, a lot of lights and a great deal of sweat. They still are, but now, they have help from technology. A nip here and a tuck there... it's all in a day's play! Movies today are being shot digitally, with live voice (no dubbing), online editing (deciding the edit points—where a shot will be edited and joined—as one shoots), and are being processed digitally.

### The Old Days

Let us first understand, though, how it happened earlier. It was relatively simple. A film would first be 'canned', meaning it would be shot on film stock in negative format. Then, it would be processed; this meant converting the negative format into positive, which could be projected. This is quite similar to the film processing we do

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